

KIT 7 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF · RUN KITS 1 AND 2 FIRST

AI for Workload: Winning Back an Hour a Week

Everything you need before you present. Read this once (about 8 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist, and you're ready.

What this session is

The whole-week session. Staff audit their real week with a two-question sort (does it require knowing my kids? does it repeat?), template their two worst repeating tasks with a build-once recipe, and, the part productivity workshops skip, write a **protected list**: the relational work that stays theirs by decision. The 20-minute lab produces a completed audit, two tested templates shared to the staff doc, and the protected list in ink.

THE STANCE: REPEAT IT UNTIL IT'S FURNITURE

Hand the repetitive to the tool; keep the relational on purpose. If a task requires knowing your kids, it's yours. If it doesn't, it's draftable.

Why the stakes are worth it: K-12 reports the highest burnout of any U.S. industry, 44% of workers and 52% of teachers "always or very often" burned out (Gallup, 2022), inside a ~54-hour week where less than half is teaching (Merrimack/EdWeek, 2022). Weekly AI users report ~5.9 hours a week back (Gallup, 2025). This session locates each teacher's share of those hours and protects what the hours are for.

Who should present it

Same bar as Kits 1–6: any confident colleague. What you must hold firmly: the protected list is not a nice moment, it's the point. If the session becomes pure efficiency, it curdles; the room needs to hear the relational work named and kept out loud. The other firm line: the burnout numbers get stated plainly, not performed; the room lives them.

One prep item matters most: the pre-session email asking staff to jot their recurring weekly tasks beforehand (or bring their planner). The audit moves fast when the raw material walks in the door. Second: add an empty "Workload" heading to the staff prompt doc. Third: skim the exit tickets from Kit 6; recurring "still want help with" answers often name this kit's best examples.

The session at a glance

Segment	Minutes	What happens
Welcome & the pile	0:00–0:06	Burnout #1 of all industries; the recoverable share

The sort	0:06–0:12	Two questions, four quadrants; what lands in the delegate pile
The automation moves	0:12–0:21	Recurring-task template (Ms. Rivera's sub plan); the recipe; batching + library
Keeping it honest	0:21–0:30	The drift risk; the protected list; spending the hour; the never list
Lab: your week	0:30–0:52	Audit → template #1 → template #2 + share → protected list
Making it stick	0:53–0:56	Inventory; honest limits; commitments; the month
First 48 hours & close	0:56–0:58	Action sheet + exit ticket

Core session is 58 minutes. For a 45-minute slot: two sort calls, one template in the lab (the second moves to First 48 Hours), two share-out voices; the script marks the cuts.

Your 15-minute prep checklist

- ☐ **Send the staff email** (2 min, two days ahead): "Before Thursday, jot every task you did last week that you'll do again, small ones included. Bring the list and a charged device; you'll leave with your two worst ones automated."
- ☐ **Add a "Workload" section** to the staff prompt doc (1 min).
- ☐ **Skim the script once** (6 min): the template recipe on slide 10 and the protected list on slide 14 are the heart; read those aloud once.
- ☐ **Click through the deck** (2 min): all 36 slides display; tracker chip top-right.
- ☐ **Print the handouts** (2 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours, Exit Ticket, one of each per person.
- ☐ **Have your own starred task ready** (2 min): the local-example moment on slide 9 lands best when you can name the repeater you templated yourself.

Room, tech & timing

Same setup as Kits 1–6: projector, Wi-Fi, pair seating, a visible clock. Timing discipline: the lab must start by 0:30. Cut discussion before you ever cut the lab; the two things you never cut are slide 14 (the protected list) and slide 16 (the never list). Watch the room on slide 2: the burnout number lands hard some places. Steady, factual, forward.

Facilitator FAQ

"Isn't this just doing more with less, again?"

Name the fear honestly: recovered time refilled with new tasks is the never list's third line, and it's stated on screen. The session's frame is sustainability, not throughput: the hour goes to teaching, planning, or leaving on time, by the teacher's choice. If leadership is in the room, this is their line to endorse out loud.

"Can AI write my IEP documentation / progress reports?"

Drafting shells and generic language, yes, with zero student information in a public tool, ever. Anything with a student's identity or record stays in district-approved systems, and every personalized judgment stays with the educator. Kit 1's rule doesn't bend for paperwork volume.

"My worst task isn't templatable (grading, meetings, duty)."

True for some piles. The audit still helps: templating the templatable frees hours that make the untemplatable survivable. Grading judgment is protected-list work anyway; Kit 4 already handed AI the materials side of assessment.

"What if the template output is mediocre?"

Templates inherit Kit 2's iteration rounds: fix content, voice, details once, and the fix is permanent because it lives in the template. Mediocre output usually means a missing context line; add it and retest.

After the session: 5 minutes

- Collect exit tickets; they double as PD documentation.
- Skim the "still want help automating" answers; they set follow-up #1's agenda.
- Note the protected-list first lines; shared anonymously at the next staff meeting, they're the best culture artifact this series produces before Kit 8.

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